



Participants' Guide

Participants' Guide — SMU LIT Hackathon 2026

Introduction

Dear all, thank you for being a part of SMU LIT Hackathon 2026. You will undergo 24H of hacking before presenting your solution to the judges during the preliminary round on Day 2. The top 4 finalists will be announced at the Closing Ceremony on Day 2, and these 4 teams will proceed to present their solutions at TechLaw.Fest 2026 on 9 September.

Schedule

Day 1 – 5 September 2026 (Sat)

Time	Event	Notes
0900	Release of Track Challenges & Registration	SMU Hall
1000	Opening Brief	
1100	Hacking Begins	
2100	Submission of Chosen Challenge + End of Day	To submit chosen Track Challenge via Notion. Closing of Classrooms

Day 2 – 6 September 2026 (Sun)

Time	Event	Notes
0900	Hacking	
1200	Submission	Submission of Slides + Tool via Notion
1300	Preliminary Round Judging	4 mins + 2 mins QnA
1430	Closing Ceremony	Announcement of Top 4 Finalists & Guest-of-Honor's Address
1500	Networking	

Day 3 – 9 September 2026 (Sun)

Time	Event	Notes
TBC	Finals	

Venue

5 September 2026 — Registration at 9am

Available Rooms for Hacking (9am – 9pm):

- YPHSL B2-03
- YPHSL B1-09
- YPHSL B1-13
- CONNEX Level 4

Available Rooms for Hacking (3:30pm – 9pm):

- YPHSL 1-02
- CIS 3-04

Teams are required to register in person. After the opening ceremony, teams may choose to stay/leave school compound to focus on your hacking.

6 September 2026 — 9am – 4:30pm

Available Rooms for Hacking (9am – 2pm):

- YPHSL B1-09
- YPHSL B1-13
- YPHSL 1-02

Judging Rooms (may also be used in the morning):

- SOSS/CIS 1-2 – Ministry of Law
- SOSS/CIS 3-2 – AITHENA
- SOSS/CIS 3-4 – Rajah and Tann
- SOSS/CIS 3-5 – Singapore Academy of Law

Closing Ceremony & Networking (2:30pm onwards) — SMU Hall

You do not need to be present in the morning – you may complete your submission online and come for preliminary judging from 1pm onwards.

9 September 2026 — TechLaw.Fest

Timing: TBC

Judging Criteria

1. Relevance to Problem Statement (30%)

Does the solution address the problem statement the team selected, and does it solve a real, well-understood pain point in that area of legal practice?

2. Technical Feasibility (25%)

Does the solution work, and is it built in a way that could realistically be developed further? Includes code quality, use of AI tools, and whether the team can explain their own build.

3. Innovation (25%)

Does the solution offer a genuinely new approach, or a meaningfully better way of solving an existing problem, within the legal-tech space?

4. Presentation Quality (20%)

Was the pitch clear, well-structured, and convincing within the 4-minute time limit, and did the team handle questions well?